

Dan, Dushanth Mahendran

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Narrative Designer | Game Designer | Unreal Engine 5 & Unity

- Narrative Designer and Game Writer with 9 years of experience developing culturally grounded worlds, branching narratives, and gameplay-integrated storytelling for PC, console, and mobile titles.
 - Production-capable narrative systems designer experienced in Unreal Engine 5 and Unity implementation, narrative pipelines, localization coordination, and cinematic scripting across global multi-language productions.
 - Currently working on Ondeh Ondeh and No Straight Roads 2 for PC and consoles.
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SKILLS

Narrative & Worldbuilding Design

- Narrative Flow, Quest Design, & RPG System Design • Linear & Non-linear Storytelling • Dialogue Trees • Worldbuilding Documentation & Lore Architecture • Adaptation of Real-World Science, History, Religion, & Mythology • Immersive Storytelling through Gameplay, Level Design, & Cutscenes

Technical Implementation & Tools

- In-Engine Implementation: Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints) & Unity • Narrative Logic & Scripting: Twine, Ink, Yarnspinner, Articy Draft • Dialogue, Cutscene, & Quest Integration • UX & UI Text Design • Project Deployment and Versioning: Jenkins, Bitbucket, GitHub, SourceTree, TortoiseSVN.

Production & Project Management

- Agile Development & Cross-Disciplinary Collaboration • Localization Coordination (15+ Languages) & Voice Actor Coordination • Live Service Content Production & Game Design Documentation • Project Management Tools: Obsidian, Notion, Trello, Jira, Goodday.
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Metronomik – Award-winning independent studio specializing in music-centric games.

Narrative Designer (October 2023 - Present)

Sole narrative designer for two upcoming Unreal Engine 5 titles, working directly with studio co-founders and cross-functional teams to build distinctive worlds inspired by Southeast Asian culture and music.

Production Pipeline & Narrative Implementation:

- Designed and implemented dialogue, overworld barks, and cinematic cutscenes directly in Unreal Engine 5 using Blueprints, and reviewed all UI and content for narrative cohesion.
- Managed large-scale narrative coordination across internal/external teams, directing voice actors, audio engineers, and localization pipelines for 11+ languages.

[Upcoming] Ondeh Ondeh (3D puzzle adventure for PC and consoles):

- Researched and adapted Southeast Asian cultural influences into gameplay and narrative systems.
- Collaborated with programmers and designers to seamlessly integrate cultural lore into the world.

[Upcoming] No Straight Roads 2 (3D action adventure for PC and consoles):

- Wrote and implemented cinematic scripts and dynamic NPC dialogue.
- Collaborated closely with other designers, audio engineers, and animators to synchronize narrative beats with the game's heavy musical mechanics.

Kurechii – Award-winning independent studio focused on unique character-driven games.

Freelance Narrative Designer (January 2023 - October 2023)

Narrative Designer and Game Writer (January 2019 - November 2022)

Served as the lead narrative designer for two globally shipped titles and as a foundational worldbuilder for the studio's shared universe, collaborating directly with the Director and cross-functional teams.

Prism Universe (World Architecture):

- Architected the foundational lore and world framework for Kurechii's shared universe spanning multiple shipped titles.
- Authored 3,000 years of history and designed a magic system grounded in real-world science and religion.
- Served as the setting of the *Postknight*, *King's League*, and *Tiny Guardians* games.

Postknight 2 (Mobile):

- Lead writer and quest designer collaborating with art and engineering teams to implement over 120 characters, 250 items, and 125 quests.
- Edited live-ops content produced by junior writers and coordinated localization for 8 languages.

King's League II (Apple Arcade, PC, and Mobile):

- Wrote and designed three distinct 9-hour branching story campaigns featuring non-linear narrative design.
- Managed large-scale narrative production by providing voice direction and coordinating localization across 15 languages.

Community Scaling:

- Built the official studio Discord server to over 10,000 members in under a year, achieving a 44.6% Week 1 retention rate and securing official Discord Partner status within the first 3 months of going live.

Weyrdworks – Award-winning studio known for eccentric, experimental experiences.

Game Designer and Writer (October 2017 - November 2018)

Served as the core writer and game designer for the mobile title *WarPods*, collaborating directly with the studio founders to build the game from concept to global launch.

WarPods (Mobile):

- Authored comprehensive background lore for all in-game characters and wrote/implemented dialogue scripts for the onboarding tutorial and subsequent level campaigns.
- Owned the level design pipeline, successfully balancing character stats and combat mechanics through iterative playtesting and community feedback.

Gameka – Mobile gamification and software development company.

Lead Game Designer, Game Design Intern (May 2017 - September 2017)

- Directed cross-functional tech and art teams to design, gamify, and implement interactive applications with Unity for multiple clients.

EDUCATION

KDU UNIVERSITY

- Bachelor of Game Development (Hons) | September 2014 - July 2017

DIGIPEN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, REDMOND

- Bachelor of Arts in Game Design (Transferred to KDU) | September 2013 - July 2014